

MASENO 2025 KCSE PREDICTION



CONFIDENTIAL EXAM

101/2

ENGLISH

PAPER 2

TIME: 2½ HOURS



NAME.....

SCHOOL..... SIGN.....

INDEX NO..... ADM NO.....

(Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education)

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE CANDIDATES

- Write your **name**, Index **number** and the name of your **school** in the spaces provided above.
- **Sign** and write **date** of examination in the spaces provided above.
- Answer **all the questions** in this question paper.
- All your answers **must** be written in the spaces provided in this question paper.

For Examiner's Use Only:

	QUESTIONS	TOTAL MARKS	SCORES
1	Comprehension	20	
2	Literary appreciation	25	
3	Poem	20	
4	Grammar	15	
	TOTAL	80	

1. COMPREHENSION

Read the following passage then answer the questions thereafter.

It is a matter of time before more ex-convicts are offloaded back into communities as authorities try to decongest prisons whose populations are above the recommended capacity.

Subject to the advice and recommendations of the power of Mercy advisory Committee (POMAC), about 900 “reformed” hardcore convicts will be released.

This will be in addition to 3,908 petty offenders released since June 1, through a presidential pardon.

The release of the huge number of prisoners comes at a time when police officers are grappling with insecurity challenges. When not on standby to deal with incidents of electoral violence, the cops have to keep tabs on criminal’s gangs that have resurfaced ahead of the General election.

Already these vicious gangs have wreaked havoc in Onganta Rongai, Mombasa and Nakuru where cops are struggling to tame them. The presence of ex-convicts among communities is, therefore, likely to make a bad situation worse. From previous experience, some of pardoned prisoners find engaging in violent robbery, burglary, motor vehicle or livestock theft irresistible.

Cops generally fear the next lot of ex-convicts coming out of prisons will relapse into crime, making their work more difficult. “Our worry is that many of them will go back into crime, this is not farfetched but a common trend based on past experiences. Once these guys are set free, the impact will be instant with crimes shooting up” says a senior police officer, who spoke to the media, representing the views of some of his colleagues.

But police spokesman Bruno Shiosso says there is no cause for alarm since officers are trained on how to deal with lawbreakers, and that ex-convicts are no exception when it comes to enforcing law and order. He said they are certain that prisons authorities will only let out those who proved beyond doubt that they have reformed and become responsible citizens.

“But for those who think they will go baaack to crime, we shall deal with them within the realms of the law,” noted Shiosso.

The police fear is understandable since recently, a former convict bludgeoned his mother to death in Riagicheru Village of Kirinyaga County. Barely days after being released from jail last month Ephantus Kiura shocked locals when he allegedly killed Grace Muthoni Ndambiri on June 12 by hitting the elderly woman with a blunt object.

Kiura had been imprisoned at the Gathigiriri Prison by a court in Mwea for torching his 76-year old mother’s house. Upon earning freedom through a presidential pardon, the man brutally killed his mother. He was among the 3,908 petty offenders released from prison in a decongestion programme.

Kiura was a beneficiary of the community service order. However, he never waited to serve the noncustodial sentence and is now staring at life behind bars for the alleged murder. Petty offenders put on this form of light punishment are required to perform a specified number of hours of unpaid work in the community. This, however, does not apply to prisoners serving jail for capital offences.

Authorities admit that it is often difficult to ascertain the prisoners who correctly merit release. Some of those who make it to the freedom list either fake having reformed or bribe prison officials-ultimately leading to the wrong individuals being reintegrated back into communities. Though stake holders have

no right prescription for selecting the right convicts for pardon, the general feeling is that more general feeling is that more attention should be put on rehabilitation of inmates to achieve the desired change. “Prisons have turned into containment facilities as opposed to rehabilitation centres where inmates and convicts are turned into responsible citizens” states Ambrose Ngare, a former prisons boss. According to Ngare, now executive director of Africa Institute of Criminology, a non-governmental organization dealing in restorative justice, it is pointless releasing prisoners without first endeavouring to reconcile them with the victims they wronged.

Questions (20 mks)

1. What is the main reason the advisory committee gives for the release of convicts? (1 mk)

.....
.....

2. Give the main concerns of the police officers in connection to the release of the ex-convicts.

(2 mks)

.....
.....
.....

3. State the crimes the offenders have been accused of engaging in. (3 mks)

.....
.....
.....
.....

4. Give the total number of ex-convicts the police officers expects in the communities. (1 mk)

.....
.....
.....

5. In about 55 words, chronologically summarise the criminal life of Ephantus Kiura. (5 mks)

.....
.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

6. Cops generally fear the next lot of ex-convicts will relapse into crime. Identify the phrasal quantifier in the sentence. (1 mk)

.....

7. Identify the attitude of the public towards the released ex-convicts. (3 mks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

8. What does the writer mean by (2 mks)
‘Prisons have turned into containment facilities as opposed to rehabilitation centres’

.....

.....

.....

9. Give the meaning of the following words. (2 mks)

i) grappling

ii) right prescription

2. Read the following excerpt and then answer the questions that follow (25 mks)

Bembe: (*Interrupting Nicole*) The matter of *The Samaritan* is weighty. It can destroy lives. It is threatening the lives of many powerful people. They are fighting back and they will destroy your life. I am giving you a chance to secure your life. I am an officer whose duty is to protect lives. Just do what the Mayor told you. You should never fight a losing battle.

Nicole: (*Firmly*) I have made a choice to do what is right. That is not negotiable. And besides, I have no control over the App. The National Information and Communications Technology Corporation is now in charge of that App.

Bembe: (*Interrupting Nicole*) I understand that to mean you are ready for a fight. And to get us started, are you aware that the signal of your phone was at one time located at the scene of murder?

Nicole: (*In horror and rising to her feet*) That's preposterous! (*Moves towards the door*) I need to see the Principal now!

Bembe: (*Blocking the way*) And what about last night?

Nicole: What?

Bembe: The school generator.

Nicole: School generator? What about it?

Bembe: Who sold it?

Nicole: That is ridiculous!

Bembe: I thought so, too.

Nicole: (*Trying to find a way past Inspector Bembe*) I have nothing to do with the school generator!

Bembe: (*Blocking her every move*) The generator has been stolen, and you and I know who stole it!

Nicole: Listen, Mr. Officer, do not try to fabricate anything against me. It will get you nowhere. And if you insist, this will become the darkest day in your career!

Bembe: What? Are you threatening a police officer?

Nicole: (*With a sharp and firm voice*) You must not break the law by accusing me of crimes I have not committed!

Bembe: You're just confirming some of the other accusations that have been made against you.

Nicole: Which allegations?

Bembe: You have a reputation for being too strong-willed to be suitable for a school teacher. You're as stubborn as a mule.

Nicole: What crime is that?

Bembe: Well, it is not a crime as such; but don't you think it is a bad influence to the students?

(*Bangs the table violently and shouts an order. Two police officers enter.*) Handcuff her! (*There is a commotion as the officers reach out to Nicole. She resists but is overpowered. There is an interval of silence as Bembe begins to rummage through papers on Nicole's table. Nicole refuses to move and sits down on the floor. The officers drag her on the floor*) Stop. (*The officers stop. There is silence. Then Bembe moves behind Nicole's table and starts pulling the drawers open, one after the other, removing and throwing papers all over the floor.*) Where have you hidden it?

Nicole: Hidden What?

Bembe: The Samaritan! *(Nicole is visibly surprised at the answer but remains silent.)* I will tell you this, whenever you see me personally involved in an arrest, you must know it's a serious matter, as serious as death. And you should be afraid. Very afraid!

Nicole: I am not guilty of anything, and I refuse to be intimidated!

Bembe: *(Inspector Bembe bangs the table violently with his gun. Nicole recoils with a start.)*
Woman! Show some seriousness! This is no laughing matter. Are you willing to talk?

Nicole: About what? *(There is silence as Inspector Bembe wears his beret and places his scepter under his armpit.)*

a) Briefly explain what Nicole was told to do by the Mayor. **(3marks)**

.....

.....

.....

.....

b) Summarize the circumstances that makes Bembe interrupt Nicole at the beginning of the excerpt **(3marks)**

.....

.....

.....

.....

c) Describe the following characters as seen in the excerpt **(4marks)**

i) Bembe

.....

.....

.....

ii) Nicole

.....

.....

.....

d) Describe the mood portrayed in the excerpt. **(3 marks)**

.....

.....

.....

.....

e) From your knowledge of the text, explain how the Samaritan works **(3 marks)**

.....

.....

.....

.....

f) Identify and state the effectiveness of two styles used in the excerpt. **(4 marks)**

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

g) Identify and illustrate one theme from the excerpt. **(2 marks)**

.....

.....

.....

h) You cannot fabricate crimes against me! (Begin: Crimes ...) **(1 mark)**

.....

.....

i) Explain the meaning as used in the excerpt. **(2 marks)**

- i) a losing battle
- ii) prepositions

3. Read the poem below and answer questions that follow:

I AM TIRED OF TALKING IN METAPHORS

I will talk plainly,
Because I am moved to abandon riddles,
I will tell you of how
We held our heads in our hands
Because the owl hooted all night
And the dogs howled as if mourning
We waited the bad news
We received it.
Our mother blinded in one eye
Crippled in the right leg
Because she did not vote
For her husband's candidate

I will remind you
Of when the peeled plantains
Stood upright in the cooking pot
We slaughtered a cock,
Anticipating an important visitor
We got her:
Our daughter – piece of flesh in a sack
Our present from her husband

No! I will not use metaphors
I will just talk to you:
I do not fight to take your place
Or to constantly wave my fist in your face
I refuse to argue about

Your “manly pact”
with my father
You’re buying me for a bag of potatoes
And pepper
All I want
Is for you to stop denying me
My presence needs no metaphors

I am here
Just as you are

I am not a machine
To dismantle whenever you whim
I demand my human dignity

Questions

a) Who is the persona in this poem? (2 mks)

.....

.....

.....

b) What are the thematic concerns of the poem. (4 mks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

c) Explain the speaker’s attitude towards the subject matter. (3 mks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

d) Give a character trait of the speaker. (2 mks)

.....

.....

e) Discuss two elements of tradition highlighted in the poem. (4 mks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

f) Identity two features of style used in the poem. (4 mks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

g) Our mother blinded in one eye. Crippled in the right leg. (Join using a conjunction) (1mk)

.....

4. GRAMMAR (15 MKS)

a) Give the meaning of the idiomatic expression used in the following sentences. (3 mks)

i) The long-awaited guests arrived at the eleventh hour.

.....

.....

ii) After thorough revision of the text the teacher told the students’ the ball is in your court.’

.....

.....

iii) After being arrested the thief spilt the beans about their spoil.

.....

.....

b) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. (3 mks)

i) Njoki did not know it was a dangerous vocation. (Rewrite using.....how.....)

.....

ii) Someone saw Kirimi leaving the plane in Khartoum. (Begin: Kirimi.....)

.....

iii) She opened the window and a bat flew out. (End in: a bat)

.....

c) Complete the following sentences using the appropriate form of the word given in

brackets.

i) Sophie's motherof her wearing very tight clothes in church. (approve)

ii) Hiscost him his job. (efficient)

iii) Theof the traveller's was hindered by the poor roads. (mobile)

d) Replace the underlined word with the gender neutral word.

i) The foreman arrived late and delayed the construction.

.....

ii) The housegirl died in the inferno.

.....

e) Explain the two different meanings in each of the following sentences. (4 mks)

i) The students will read the books in the library.

.....

.....

.....

ii) The man looked at the cow with one eye.

.....

.....

.....